PODS

Find your people. Join the moment.

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Finding your people on campus is broken.

Too scattered

GroupMe threads, club emails, Instagram stories — no single place to find people.

No real intent

Social media shows everything. No place to say: I want to play basketball at 3pm today.

No structure

Joining a group has no approval layer, anyone can crash your activity or event.

Stakeholders: Students wanting to organize · Students wanting to connect · Campus community/Organizations

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SOLUTION

PODS

A mobile app where students post activities, create interest groups, and connect with real people — with host-controlled approval.

- Post an activity (time, place, capacity)
- Browse & join public Pods
- Request to join → host approves or rejects
- Real-time group chat once accepted

Built for campus. Built for real connection.

5 Core Use Cases

UC1

Registration & Auth

.edu email validation · Firebase Auth · Secure login

UC2

Pod Creation

Name, description, capacity · Host controls

UC3

Activity Creation

Time, location, join limit · Linked to pod

UC4

Join Request Flow & live chat

Request → Host approves or rejects
Live chat via Firebase Realtime DB · WebSocket

UC5

Pod Discovery & Joining

User joins an already existing pod

Non-Functional: Security (auth-only DB access) · Real-time performance (WebSocket messaging) · .edu domain enforcement

Three-Layer Architecture

FRONTEND

React Native + Expo

Auth · Discover · Pods
Messages · Profile
React Navigation v7

FIRESTORE

Primary Database

Users · Pods · Activities
Structured queries
Document model

RTDB

Realtime Database

Pod chats · Messages
WebSocket / onValue
Low-latency sync

Key Decision: Firestore for structured queries (public pod discovery) · Realtime DB for low-latency chat (WebSocket)

Tech Stack

- React Native + Expo
- TypeScript
- Firebase Auth
- Cloud Firestore
- Firebase Realtime DB
- GitHub

Testing

- End-to-end manual testing on physical iOS device
- Join request flow: approve, reject, full-capacity edge case
- Real-time chat sync verified across 2 devices simultaneously
- .edu email enforcement — non-.edu blocked at registration
- All 5 use cases validated live in Expo Go

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LIVE DEMO

Register (.edu) — Discover Pods — Create Activity — Request to Join — Host Approves — Live Chat

⭐ *The demo link is below:*

https://youtu.be/qm7vZyvVc5k

We built PODS.

A campus social platform — end to end.
From use cases on paper to a live app on your phone.

THANK YOU!

PODS TEAM